

I've spent 4,397 hours listening to music.

That's 183 days, more than half a year of my life. So I gave Python every Spotify play I've made since May 2022, because I wanted to know something Wrapped never tells me: what do 91,210 listens actually say about the person doing the listening?



INSIDE

PROLOGUE

The questions Spotify Wrapped never asks 2

PART ONE · HOW I LOVE

01 The soundtrack has a main character 3

02 Apparently, I don't casually discover songs 4

03 Some songs I didn't listen to. I moved into them. 5

04 The songs that refused to leave 6

05 The Eras Tour, unfortunately starring me 7

06 But I'm not as loyal as that makes me sound 8

PART TWO · HOW IT FELT

07 Four years of emotional weather 9

08 My saddest-sounding night was also an all-nighter 10

PART THREE · HOW MY DAYS GO

09 So... when does Suhani sleep? 11

10 The all-nighters 12

11 Daylight me vs. 2 AM me 13

12 Somewhere around 5 PM, I need music 14

PART FOUR · HOW I'VE CHANGED

13 Then I graduated and moved to Austin 15

14 How desi is my Spotify? 16

15 Who gets two seconds to impress me? 17

16 Am I the same listener I was in 2022? 18

EPILOGUE

So what did all these listens tell me? 19

APPENDIX

Okay, but can you trust any of this? 20



The receipts: my 20 most-played songs after the four above.

The questions Spotify Wrapped never asks

Spotify has spent four years collecting enough data to answer very personal questions about how I listen. Nobody asks them. So I did.

Who is the main character of my soundtrack?

43/53

months had Ariana Grande at #1.

→ PAGE 3

How fast do I get obsessed with a song?

<24 hours

"Ghagra" went from first play to 25 plays.

→ PAGE 4

What's the most times I've played one song in a row?

122

"Until I Found You", nothing in between.

→ PAGE 5

What's my longest relationship with a song?

5 years

"One Last Time" never left my top 20.

→ PAGE 6

Which song did I bring back from the dead?

530 days

of silence before "It Ain't Me (with Selena Gomez)" came back.

→ PAGE 6

How many songs never got a second chance?

1,802

songs, 39% of all I've tried, got one listen.

→ PAGE 8

What did my saddest-sounding day sound like?

65×

"eternal sunshine" on Apr 1, 2025, all night.

→ PAGE 10

So... when do I sleep?

~1 AM

is when the music usually stops. Spotify stays dark until mid-morning.

→ PAGE 11

How many all-nighters have I pulled?

30

nights with music every hour from midnight to 6 AM.

→ PAGE 12

Who is 2 AM me?

2.62×

more Shashwat Sachdev after midnight. 2 AM me is desi.

→ PAGE 13

What did moving to Austin change?

10.4→16%

of my listening now happens after midnight.

→ PAGE 15

How long do I give a song?

1.8s

before I skip it, on a typical skip.

→ PAGE 17

The soundtrack has a main character

When I love something, I stay. Ariana Grande has basically been my roommate.

43 / 53

months had the same #1 artist: **Ariana Grande**. She's 28% of everything I've listened to since 2022.

53 MONTHS · ONE STRIP PER MONTH, COLORED BY WHO WON IT



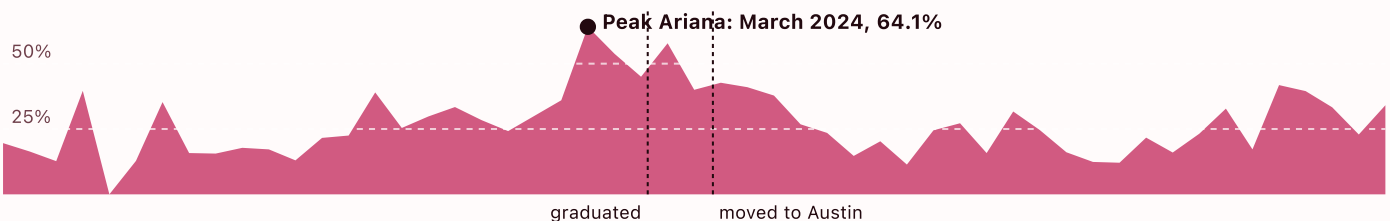
1,212
HOURS OF ARIANA GRANDE

vs.

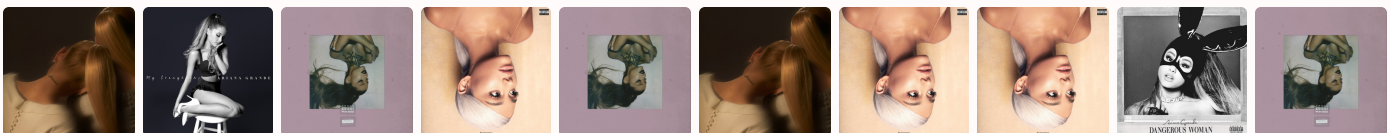
945
HOURS OF MY NEXT FOUR ARTISTS,
COMBINED

THE ARIANA TIDE · HER SHARE OF EACH MONTH

How much of my life is Ariana?



MY TEN MOST-PLAYED SONGS: 1 THROUGH 10, ALL ARIANA GRANDE



THE ROYAL SUCCESSION · THE ONLY MONTHS SHE LOST



She isn't my favorite artist. She's the background of my life: 28% of everything I've played, and on 87% of the days I listened to anything, she was in it.

Peak Ariana was March 2024: 64.1% of everything I played, the spring before I graduated. Only 10 months ever got away from her, 5 of them to Taylor Swift.

Apparently, I don't casually discover songs

How long does it take me to become obsessed? Sometimes less than 24 hours.

THE OBSESSION FUSE · FROM THE FIRST PLAY TO THE 25TH

How fast the fuse burns



Ghagra

Pritam · first play Feb 8, 2023



Die For You - Remix

The Weeknd · first play Feb 24, 2023



Taras - From "Munjya"

Sachin-Jigar · first play Dec 10, 2024



Ghost

Justin Bieber · first play Mar 4, 2023



Raanjhan (From "Do Patti")

Sachet-Parampara · first play Feb 19, 2025



Close To You

Gracie Abrams · first play Mar 1, 2025

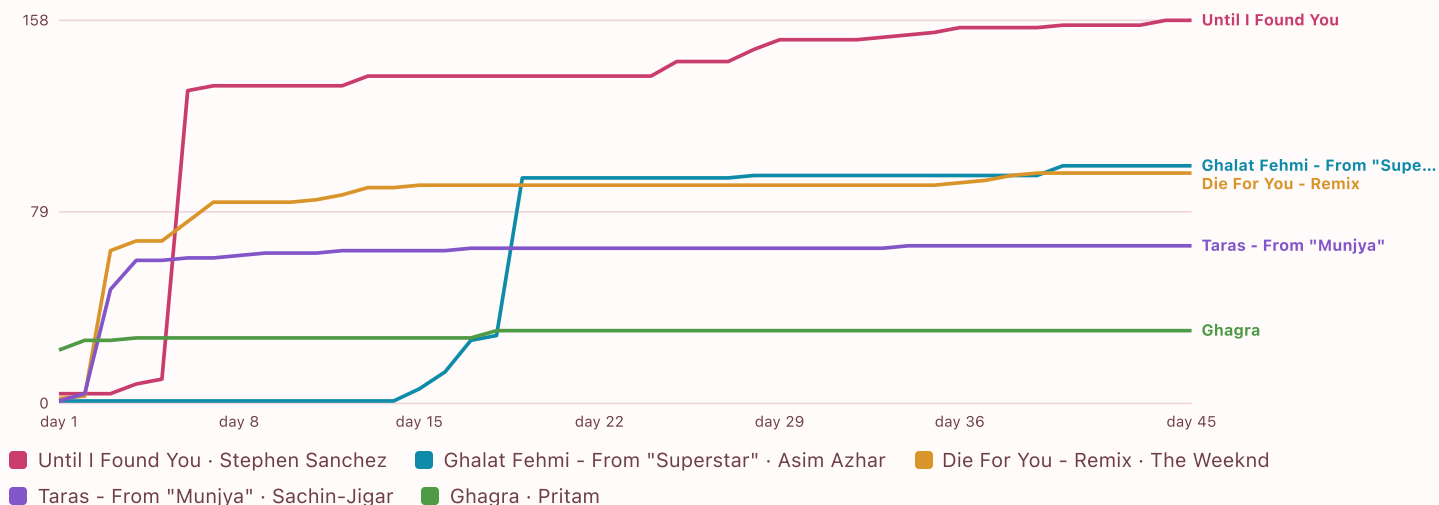


first play

25th play, 5 days later →

OBSESSION CURVES · TOTAL LISTENS IN THE FIRST 45 DAYS

What happens after the explosion

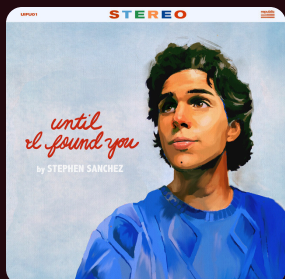


Sometimes I know immediately. "Ghagra" went from first listen to 25 listens by the next day. None of my fastest obsessions took even a week.

An obsession is a cliff, not a slope. "Until I Found You" hit 131 listens in its first week, then flattened. Most of the first month happens in a few wild days.

Some songs I didn't listen to. I moved into them.

At some point this stopped being a song and became interior decoration.

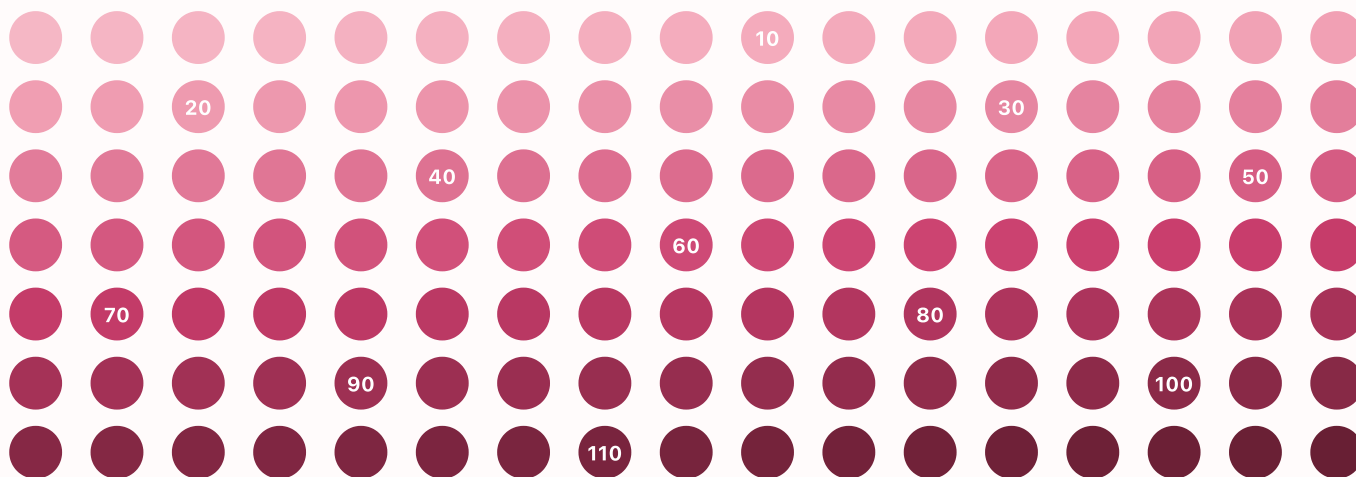


MONDAY, JANUARY 9, 2023

119× Until I Found You

Stephen Sanchez. In one day. That's about 6 hours of the same song, if you were wondering whether I listen casually.

119 PLAYS OF "UNTIL I FOUND YOU" ON JAN 9, 2023, ONE DOT EACH



ONE SONG, ONE DAY

The runners-up

1		better off Ariana Grande, Jul 3, 2023	106×
2		Pehla Pyaar Vishal Mishra, Apr 25, 2023	87×
3		Ghalat Fehmi - From "Superstar" Asim Azhar, May 11, 2023	65×
4		eternal sunshine Ariana Grande, Apr 1, 2025	65×

122 times in a row. "Until I Found You" started at 10:57 PM on Jan 8, 2023 and didn't let another song play until 12:36 PM on Jan 10, 2023. On Jan 9, 2023, it was the only song I played all day.

BACK TO BACK, NOTHING IN BETWEEN

My records for "again"

1		Until I Found You Stephen Sanchez, Jan 8, 2023	122 in a row
2		Pehla Pyaar Vishal Mishra, Apr 24, 2023	110 in a row
3		better off Ariana Grande, Jul 3, 2023	102 in a row
4		Ghalat Fehmi - From "Superstar" Asim Azhar, May 11, 2023	61 in a row
5		Die For You - Remix The Weeknd, Feb 26, 2023	59 in a row

Repeat is a lifestyle. 10% of all my listens (9,130) are the same song I'd just finished, played again.

CALENDAR STRIPS • ONE SQUARE FOR EVERY DAY IN A ROW

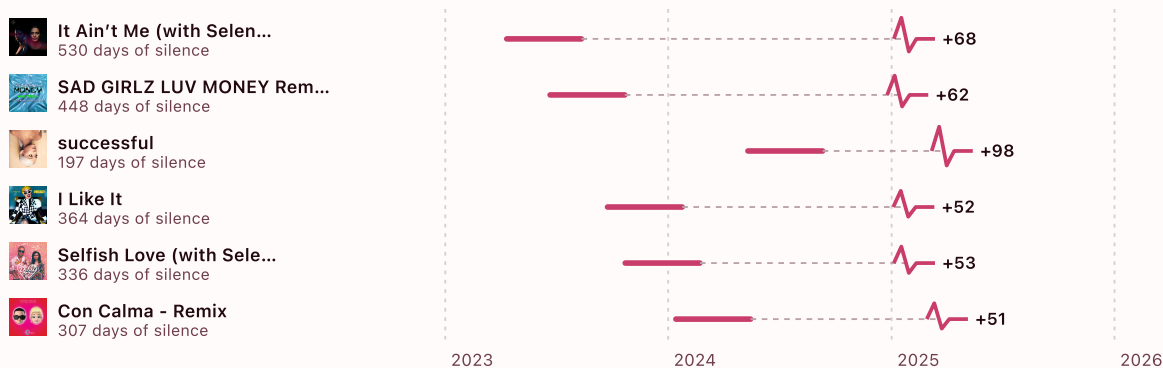
	intro (end of the world) Apr 1, 2024 → Apr 21		21
	Dangerous Woman Jul 10, 2025 → Jul 25		16
	eternal sunshine Apr 7, 2024 → Apr 21		15
	don't wanna break up again Apr 7, 2024 → Apr 21		15
	Lush Life Apr 10, 2024 → Apr 24		15
	we can't be friends (wait f... May 6, 2024 → May 20		15
	like i do Aug 14, 2026 → Aug 27		14
	On & On Jun 13, 2025 → Jun 25		13



One Last Time

2022 #17 · 2023 #7 · 2024 #20 · 2025 #13 · 2026 #19

Songs that came back from the dead



My longest era: "intro (end of the world)", every day for 21 days starting Apr 1, 2024.

6

The Eras Tour, unfortunately starring me

Every year had a song, an artist and a mood. Let the music speak for itself.



2022 **deja vu**

Olivia Rodrigo · 57 listens. *The opening act. Mostly songs I would carry for years.*

205 h · 2 a day

711 new songs

#1: Ariana Grande



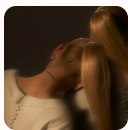
2023 **better off**

Ariana Grande · 269 listens. *Everything, all at once. The year I listened and discovered the most.*

1,622 h · 4.5 a day

1,830 new songs

#1: Ariana Grande



2024 **we can't be friends (wait for your love)**

Ariana Grande · 292 listens. *Graduation, then a quiet summer. Back to what was safe.*

724 h · 2.2 a day

315 new songs

#1: Ariana Grande



2025 **like JENNIE**

JENNIE · 281 listens. *First full year in Austin. I left home musically, too.*

1,041 h · 3 a day

1,109 new songs

#1: Ariana Grande



2026 **Run Down The City - Monica**

Shashwat Sachdev · 294 listens. *A Bollywood soundtrack takes the crown.*

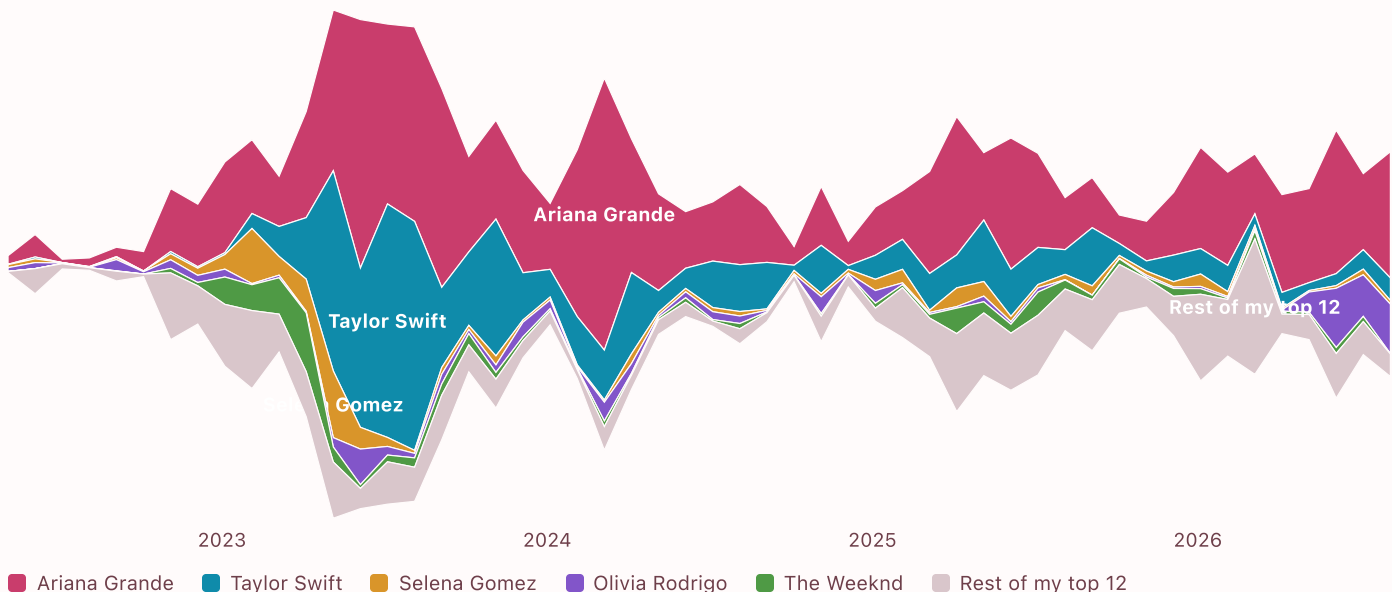
804 h · 3 a day

683 new songs

#1: Ariana Grande

STREAMGRAPH · HOURS PER MONTH OF MY TOP ARTISTS

Who replaced whom

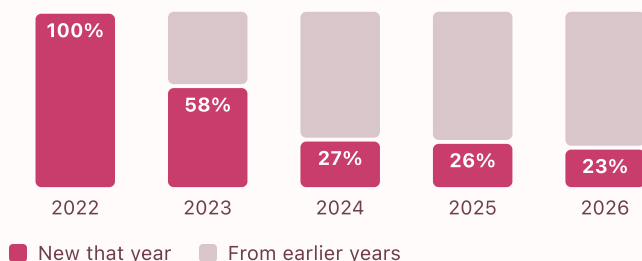


But I'm not as loyal as that makes me sound

Some years I explored. Some years I came home.

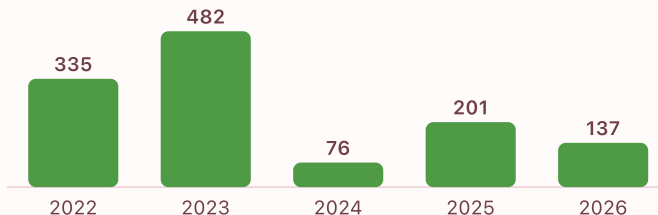
STACKED COLUMNS · SHARE OF LISTENS

New songs vs. songs I already knew



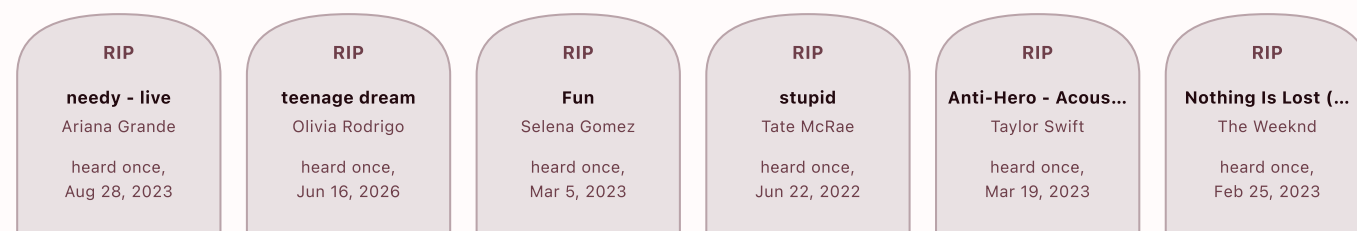
COLUMN CHART

New artists I found each year



THE GRAVEYARD · SONGS THAT GOT EXACTLY ONE LISTEN

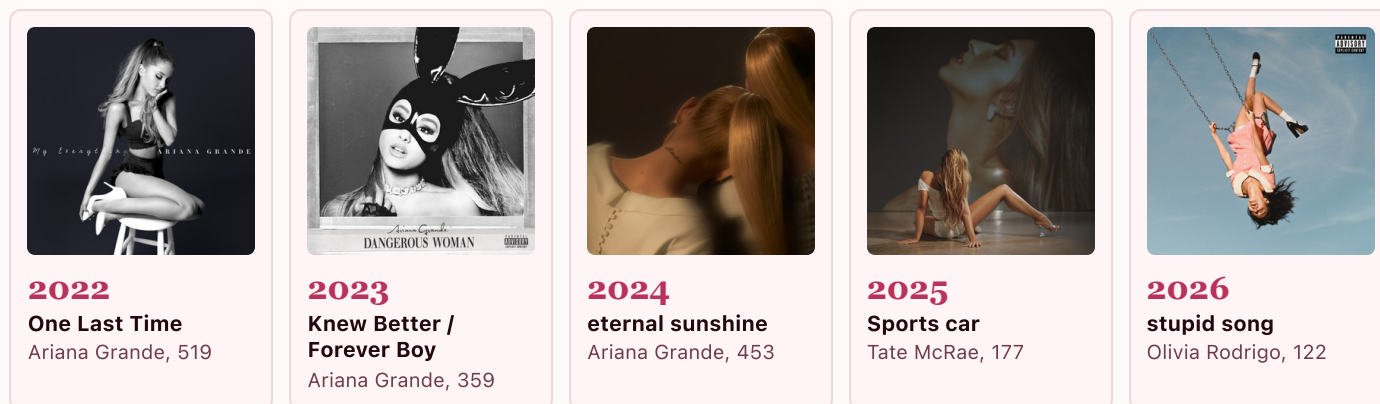
1,802 songs, 39% of every song I've tried, never got a second listen



Even my favorite artists have songs in here: one from each of my top six.

BEST FINDS

The other great find of each year



2023: I went exploring. 1,830 new songs and 482 new artists.

2024: I came home. Only 315 new songs, the fewest of any full year, my senior spring and the summer before college.

2025: I left again. 1,109 new songs, my first full year in Austin.

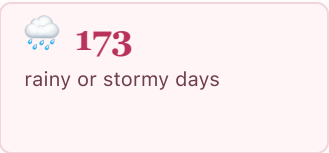
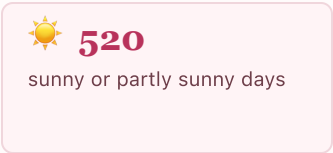
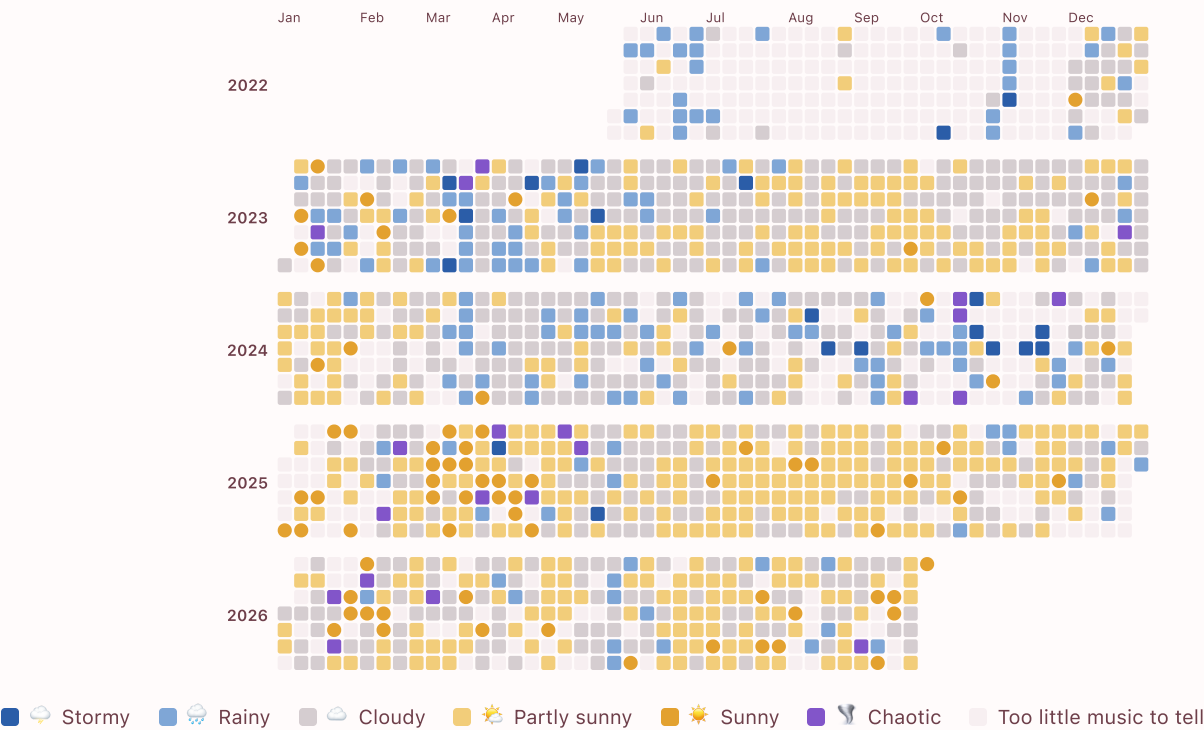
The soundtrack moved too: "deja vu" → "better off" → "we can't be friends (wait for your love)" → "like JENNIE" → "Run Down The City - Monica".

Four years of emotional weather

Spotify can't tell me how I felt. It can tell me what my music sounded like.

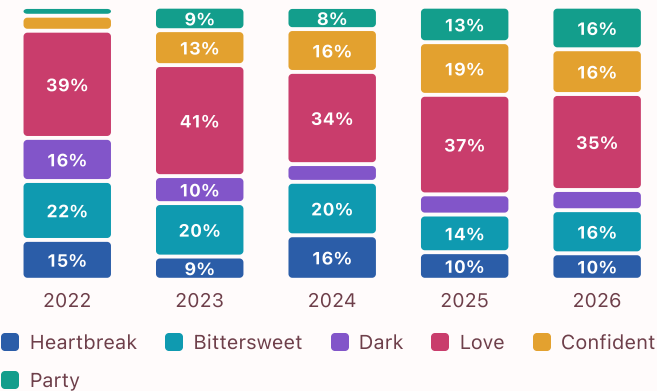
WEATHER CALENDAR · ONE SQUARE PER DAY

The forecast for every day I listened



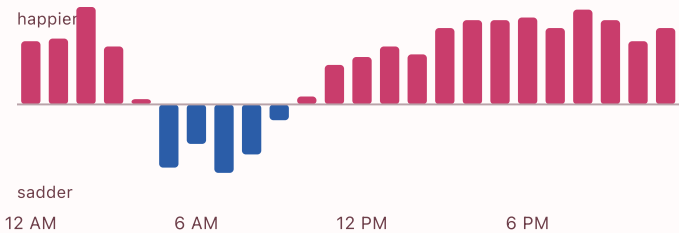
100% STACKED COLUMNS

The mood of each year



DIVERGING BARS · BY HOUR

Is late-night me sadder?



Moods are my own labels for my 389 most-played songs (61.5% of my listens), not Spotify data. 2022 was my rainiest year: 52% of labeled listens were heartbreak, bittersweet or dark, vs. 33% in 2026. The sad hours are 5 to 8 AM, the ones I'm usually still up for, not up early for.

My saddest-sounding night was also an all-nighter

The highs, the lows, and the day my music couldn't decide.

☁ THE LOWS

Saddest-sounding days



Tuesday, April 1, 2025
"eternal sunshine" 65x · Ariana Grande
score -1.31 · all-nighter



Tuesday, July 11, 2023
"vampire" 13x · Olivia Rodrigo
score -1.14



Thursday, May 11, 2023
"Ghalat Fehmi - From 'Superstar'" 65x · Asim Azhar
score -0.97

☀ THE HIGHS

Happiest-sounding days



Thursday, February 5, 2026
"Run Down The City - Monica" 40x · Shashwat Sachdev
score +1.96



Thursday, February 12, 2026
"Run Down The City - Monica" 44x · Shashwat Sachdev
score +1.52



Monday, September 30, 2024
"New Romantics (Taylor's Version)" 40x · Taylor Swift
score +1.47

☁ My most emotionally chaotic day: Monday, March 20, 2023

85 labeled listens that swung between every mood, the widest spread of any day (1.72 on a scale where the moods run from -2 to +2).

And the saddest-sounding day, Tuesday, April 1, 2025, was an all-nighter: music from just after midnight until morning, with "eternal sunshine" on repeat 65 times.

THE SOUNDTRACK OF EACH FEELING

My most-played song in every mood

Heartbreak
we can't be friends (wait for your love)
Ariana Grande, 542

Bittersweet
everytime
Ariana Grande, 488

Dark
bad idea
Ariana Grande, 455

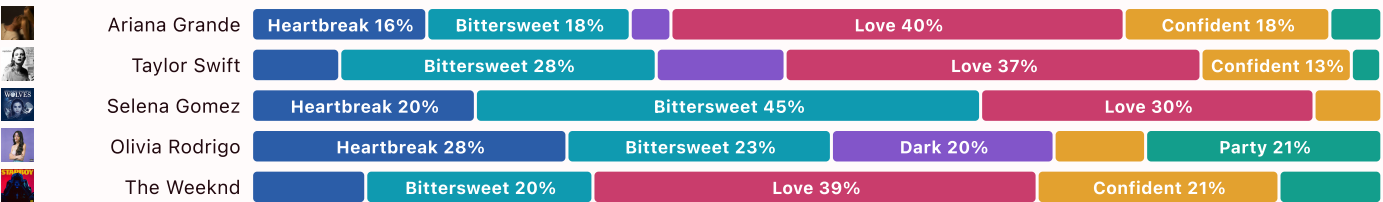
Love
goodnight n go
Ariana Grande, 411

Confident
bloodline
Ariana Grande, 495

Party
Run Down The City - Monica
Shashwat Sachdev, 294

100% STACKED BARS

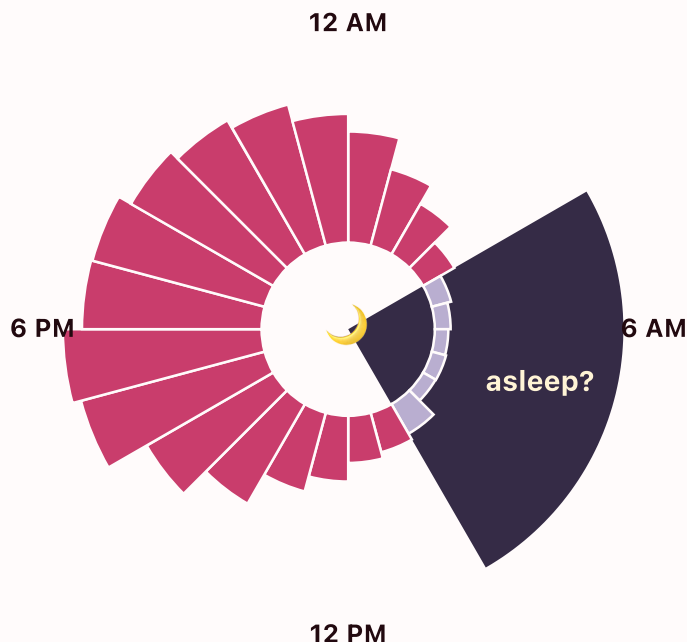
What my top artists sound like to me



So... when does Suhani sleep?

Spotify can't tell me when I'm asleep. It can tell me when I finally stop pressing play.

RADIAL CLOCK · SHARE OF ALL MY LISTENING
BY HOUR



THE QUIET WINDOW, BY YEAR

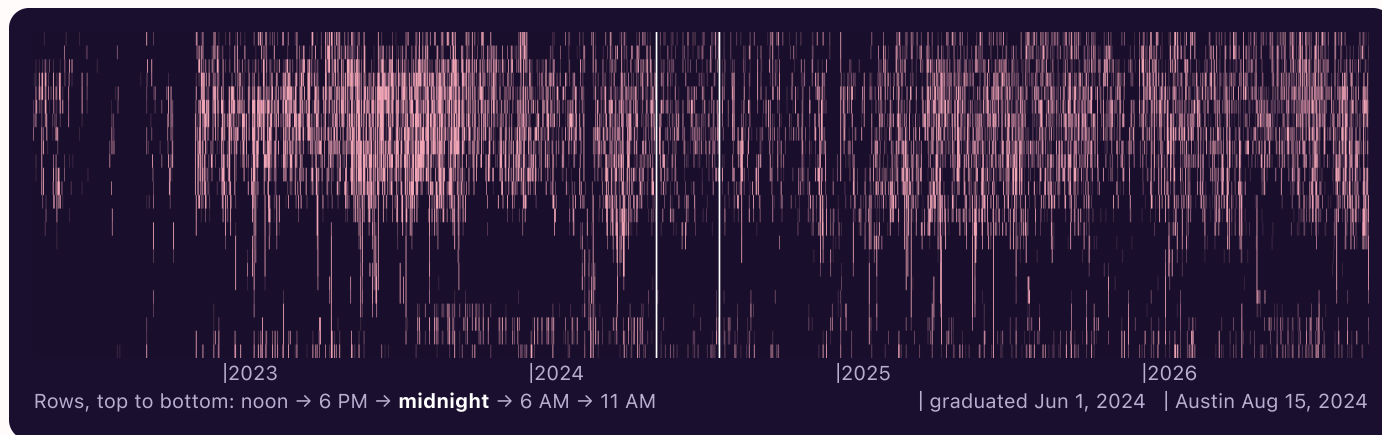
When Spotify goes dark

2022	🌙 4 AM → 10 AM	high school
2023	🌙 3 AM → 9 AM	high school
2024	🌙 3 AM → 9 AM	graduated in May, moved in August
2025	🌙 4 AM → 10 AM	Austin
2026	🌙 4 AM → 10 AM	Austin

The six hours each year when I'm least likely to be listening.

WERE YOU AWAKE? · EVERY DAY (LEFT TO RIGHT) × EVERY HOUR (TOP TO BOTTOM)

1,592 days of my rhythm



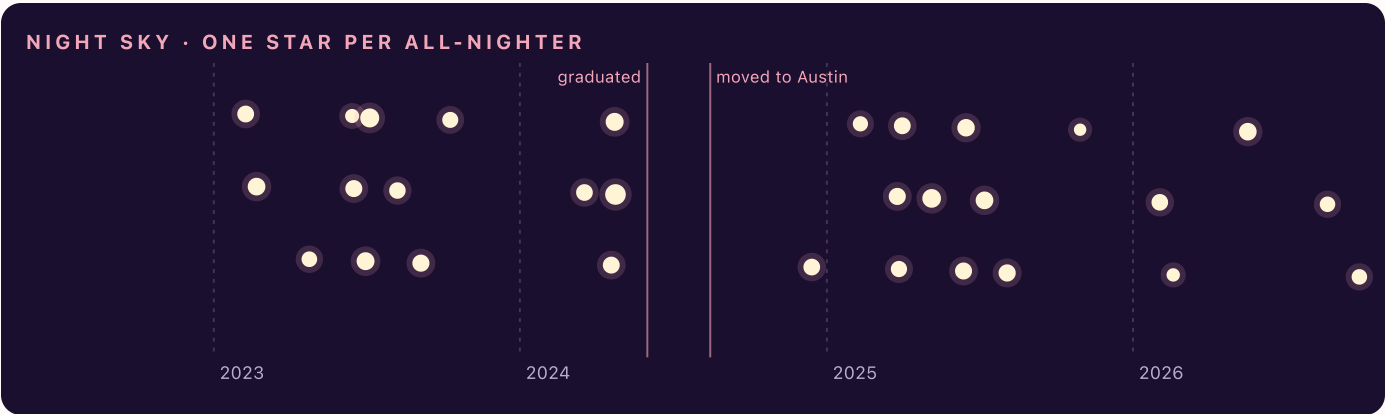
Each pixel is one hour of one day; brighter means more music. The dark band is the hours I'm almost never listening. The bright lines cutting through it are all-nighters.

My best guess: the music usually stops around 1 AM and Spotify stays dark until mid-morning. The quiet window across all four years runs 4 AM to 10 AM.

Did college destroy my bedtime? A little. After midnight went from 10.4% of my listening in high school to 16% in Austin, and the quiet window has started an hour later since 2025.

The all-nighters

Nights my music never stopped. Probable overnight listening, not confirmed wakefulness.



30

all-nighters: music in every hour from midnight to 6 AM

10 · 5 · 10 · 5

2023 · 2024 · 2025 · 2026

8

of them in April, May or December, a.k.a. finals

Sep 28

the most recent one (2026)

THE LONGEST NIGHTS

Sessions that ran past sunrise

- 13.6h**

Sunday, March 17, 2024
11:32 PM → 3:07 PM the next day
375 songs started, no break longer than 30 minutes.
girl???
- 10h**

Thursday, May 11, 2023
2:27 AM → 1:06 PM
172 songs started, no break longer than 30 minutes.
girl???
- 12.8h**

Monday, July 7, 2025
11:06 PM → 12:27 PM the next day
266 songs started, no break longer than 30 minutes.
girl???

MIDNIGHT TO 5 AM

My 3 AM songs

- | | | | |
|---|--|--|-----|
| 1 | | eternal sunshine
Ariana Grande | 106 |
| 2 | | we can't be friends (wait for your love)
Ariana Grande | 97 |
| 3 | | Pehla Pyaar
Vishal Mishra | 84 |
| 4 | | Run Down The City - Monica
Shashwat Sachdev | 75 |
| 5 | | better off
Ariana Grande | 73 |

EVERY ONE OF THEM

- Feb 8, 2023
- Feb 21, 2023
- Apr 25, 2023
- Jun 15, 2023
- Jun 17, 2023
- Jul 1, 2023
- Jul 6, 2023
- Aug 8, 2023
- Sep 5, 2023
- Oct 10, 2023
- Mar 18, 2024
- Apr 19, 2024
- Apr 23, 2024
- Apr 24, 2024
- Dec 14, 2024
- Feb 10, 2025
- Mar 26, 2025
- Mar 28, 2025
- Apr 1, 2025
- May 6, 2025
- Jun 13, 2025
- Jun 16, 2025
- Jul 8, 2025
- Aug 4, 2025
- Oct 30, 2025
- Feb 2, 2026
- Feb 18, 2026
- May 18, 2026
- Aug 21, 2026
- Sep 28, 2026

The record: Sunday, March 17, 2024, from 11:32 PM straight through to 3:07 PM the next day: 13.6 hours of music with no real break.

They come in clusters, around exams and big weeks: back-to-back nights on April 23 and 24, 2024, a month before graduation, and a run of them in spring 2025.

Daylight me vs. 2 AM me

Apparently daytime Suhani and nighttime Suhani don't get the same aux privileges.

WHO'S OVER-REPRESENTED WHEN · COMPARED WITH MY WHOLE DAY

The artists who own each part of my day

Morning me

6–11 AM

-  **Cashmere Cat**
1.87x as likely · 40
-  **Ariana Grande**
1.62x as likely · 3,002
-  **Selena Gomez**
1.14x as likely · 220
-  **Olivia Rodrigo**
1.09x as likely · 191

Afternoon me

12–5 PM

-  **Tate McRae**
1.35x as likely · 1,064
-  **Addison Rae**
1.34x as likely · 116
-  **Demi Lovato**
1.22x as likely · 70
-  **Shawn Mendes**
1.19x as likely · 119

Evening me

6–11 PM

-  **Stephen Sanchez**
1.46x as likely · 179
-  **King**
1.31x as likely · 90
-  **BLACKPINK**
1.3x as likely · 113
-  **SZA**
1.24x as likely · 130

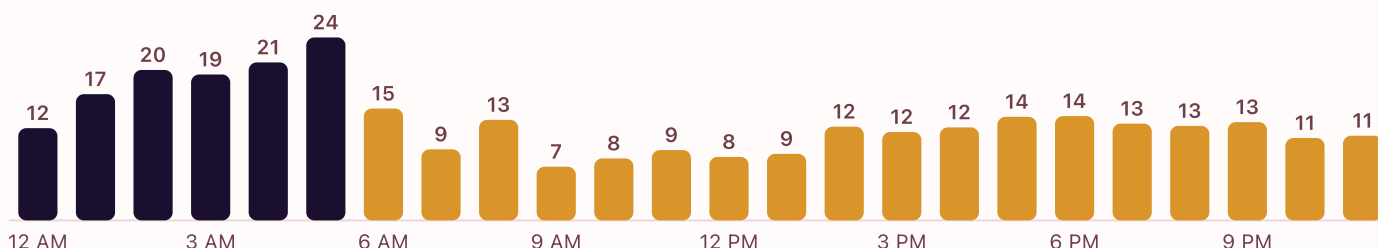
2 AM me

midnight–5 AM

-  **Shashwat Sachdev**
2.62x as likely · 205
-  **Neha Kakkar**
2.29x as likely · 71
-  **Vishal Mishra**
2.12x as likely · 133
-  **AP Dhillon**
2.01x as likely · 157

COLUMN CHART · DESI SHARE OF MY LISTENING BY HOUR

The later it gets, the more desi it gets



NOON TO 5 PM

Afternoon me plays

-  **everytime**
Ariana Grande **193**
-  **One Last Time**
Ariana Grande **188**
-  **bloodline**
Ariana Grande **172**
-  **in my head**
Ariana Grande **163**
-  **bad idea**
Ariana Grande **161**

MIDNIGHT TO 5 AM

2 AM me plays

-  **eternal sunshine**
Ariana Grande **106**
-  **we can't be friends (wait for your love)**
Ariana Grande **97**
-  **Pehla Pyaar**
Vishal Mishra **84**
-  **Run Down The City - Monica**
Shashwat Sachdev **75**
-  **better off**
Ariana Grande **73**

And Sunday me? Aashir Wajahat, 2.2x as likely on a Sunday as any other day.

2 AM me is desi. All four artists most over-represented after midnight are South Asian: Shashwat Sachdev, Neha Kakkar, Vishal Mishra, AP Dhillon. Shashwat Sachdev is 2.62x as likely to be playing then as at any other time.

Morning me belongs to Ariana, and the desi share bottoms out at 7.1% around 9 AM, then climbs to 24.2% at 5 AM.

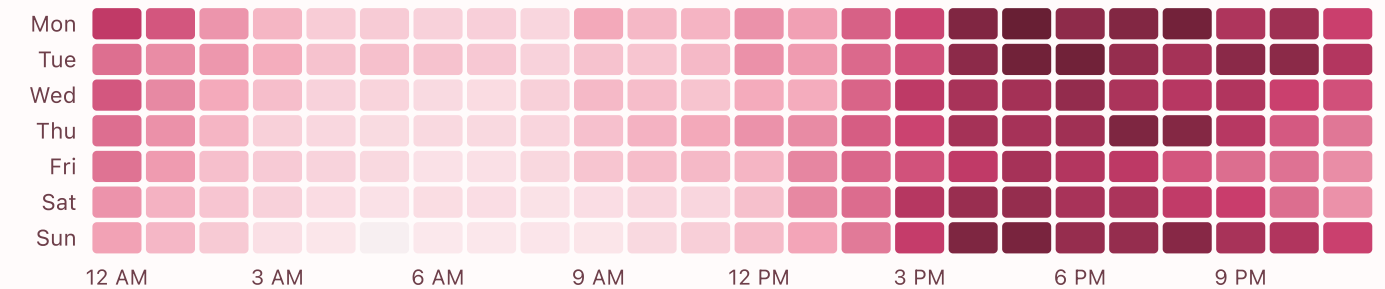
So the sun setting does change something: not how much I listen, but which language I listen in.

Somewhere around 5 PM, I need music

Different years. Suspiciously similar appointment.

HEATMAP · HOURS BY WEEKDAY AND HOUR

My listening week



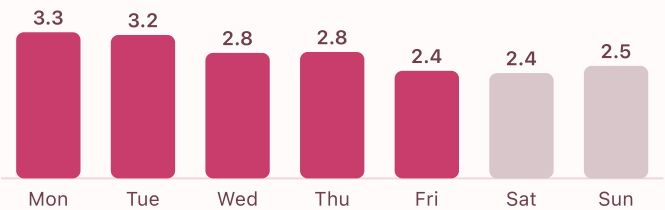
LISTENING CLOCKS · THE PEAK HOUR EACH YEAR

The appointment



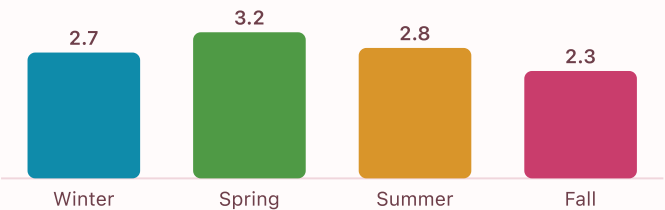
COLUMN CHART

Average hours by weekday



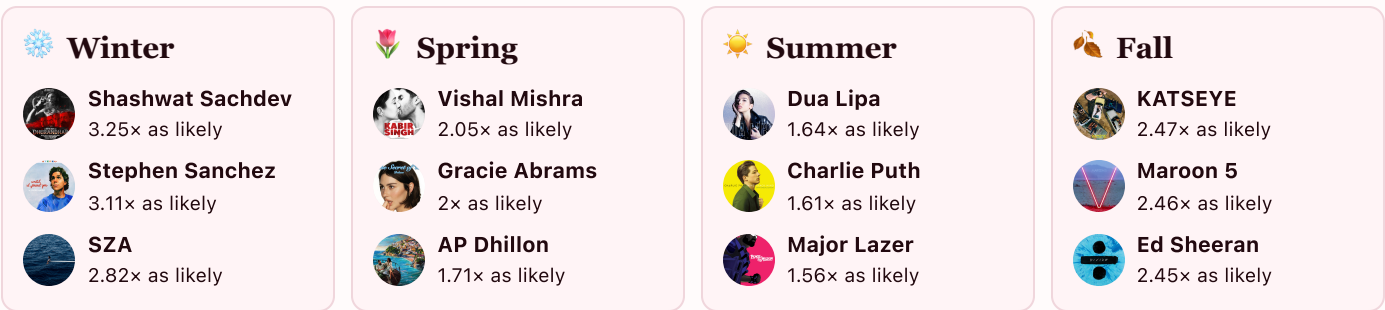
COLUMN CHART

Average hours per day by season



SEASONAL ARTISTS · WHO SHOWS UP FAR MORE IN ONE SEASON

Which artists only exist in my life when it's cold?



The appointment: 5 PM → 5 PM → 7 PM → 6 PM → 4 PM.
Every year, my music peaks in the late afternoon, right when the school day (and later, the class day) lets out.

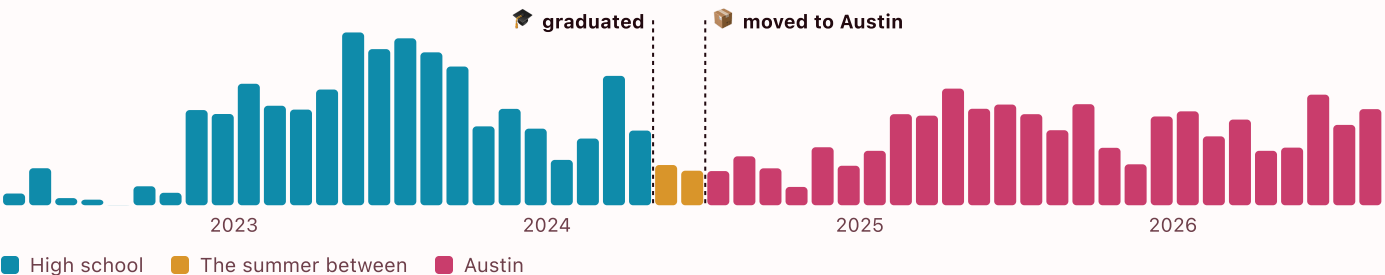
Busiest hour of the whole week: Monday at 5 PM.
Mondays are my biggest day; weekends are my quietest. Music is how I get through the week, not how I spend the weekend.

Then I graduated and moved to Austin

Here's what changed in my listening around the same time. Not because of it, necessarily. Around it.

HOURS PER MONTH, WITH MY LIFE'S TURNING POINTS

Four years, three eras



High school

May 21, 2022 – May 31, 2024

Hours a day **3.04 h**

better off
the song of the era, 294x

The summer between

Jun 1, 2024 – Aug 14, 2024

Hours a day **1.36 h**

Thinking Bout You
the song of the era, 58x

Austin

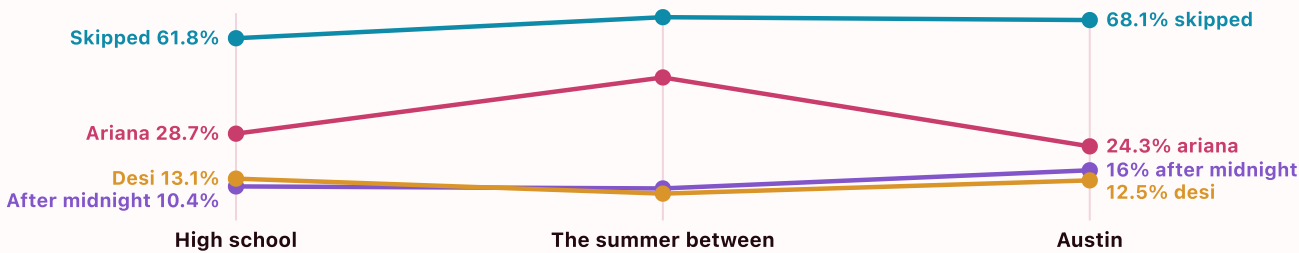
Aug 15, 2024 – Sep 28, 2026

Hours a day **2.63 h**

we can't be friends (wait for your love)
the song of the era, 330x

SLOPE CHART · EACH LINE IS ONE HABIT, ACROSS THE THREE ERAS

What moved, and which way



THE ARTISTS I LISTENED TO LESS · HOURS A MONTH, HIGH SCHOOL → AUSTIN

1		Taylor Swift	16 → 7.4 h
2		Selena Gomez	3.1 → 1.6 h
3		Pritam	1.9 → 1 h

The summer between was the quietest stretch of my life: 1.36 hours a day, less than half of high school's 3.04, and 48.2% of it was Ariana. Between graduating and leaving, I went back to what was safe.

THE ARTISTS WHO MOVED IN · HOURS A MONTH, HIGH SCHOOL → AUSTIN

1		Tate McRae	0.1 → 3.2 h
2		Rihanna	0.3 → 2.6 h
3		Sabrina Carpenter	0.7 → 2 h

Austin made me a night owl. After-midnight listening went from 10.4% to 16%. College nights are real.

But Austin also loosened her grip: Ariana fell from 28.7% in high school to 24.3%, the lowest of any era, as new artists moved in.

How desi is my Spotify?

Not a footnote: one in eight of my listens.

12.6%

of all my listens are desi

24.2%

at 5 AM, the most desi hour

January '25

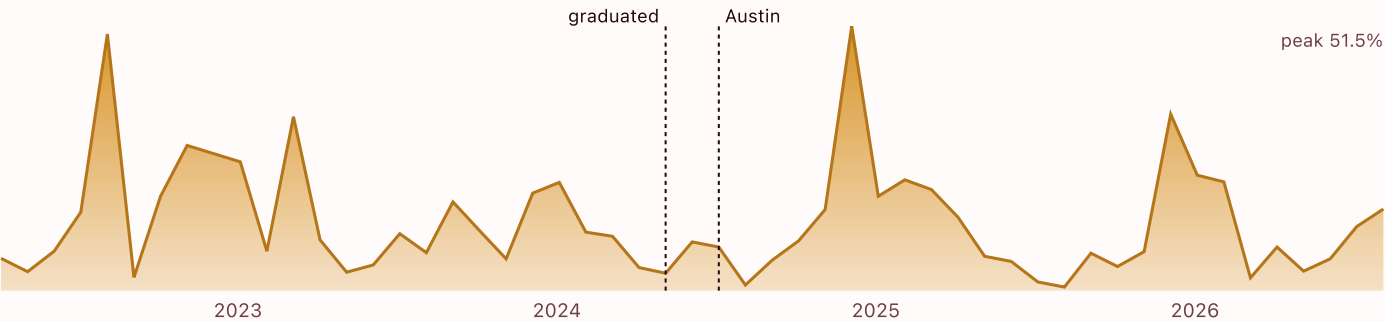
most desi month (51.5%)

18 · 13 · 11 · 12 · 14

2022 · 2023 · 2024 · 2025 · 2026 (%)

AREA CHART · DESI SHARE OF EACH MONTH

When the desi music comes out



MY MOST-PLAYED DESI ARTISTS



Pritam
1,322



Arijit Singh
591



Shashwat Sa...
565



AP Dhillon
564



Vishal Mishra
452



Sachin-Jigar
442



Diljit Dosanjh
434



Guru Randha...
367

MY MOST-PLAYED DESI SONGS



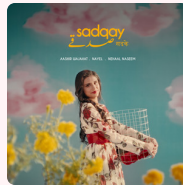
Run Down The City - Monica
Shashwat Sachdev, 294



With You
AP Dhillon, 236



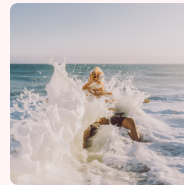
Pehla Pyaar
Vishal Mishra, 215



Sadqay
Aashir Wajahat, 154



Ghalat Fehmi - From "Superstar"
Asim Azhar, 146



Kinni Kinni
Diljit Dosanjh, 143

It comes in waves, not a steady stream. Some months are barely desi at all; others go past 50%. A Bollywood soundtrack drops, and it takes over.

2022 was my most desi year (18.2%), it dipped to 10.6% in 2024, and it's climbing again: 14.4% in 2026.

And it's my night music. Twice as desi at 4 AM as at noon (chapter 9).

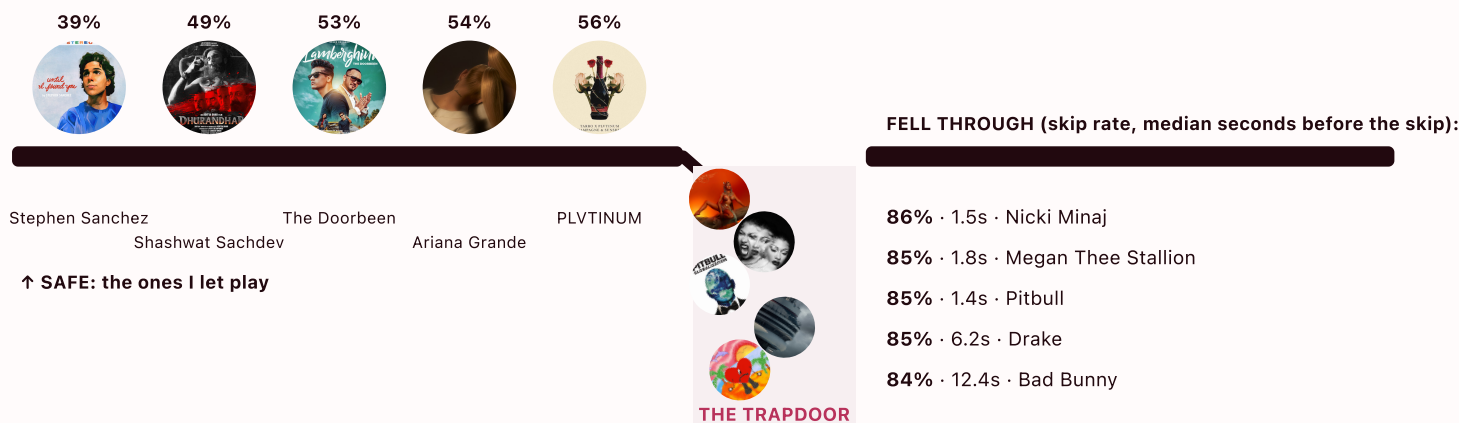
Who gets two seconds to impress me?

My Spotify isn't only what I chose. It's also what I rejected, usually very fast.

1.8s is how long a song usually gets before I skip it. Not three seconds. **Under two.** And 3 of my five most-skipped artists get even less.

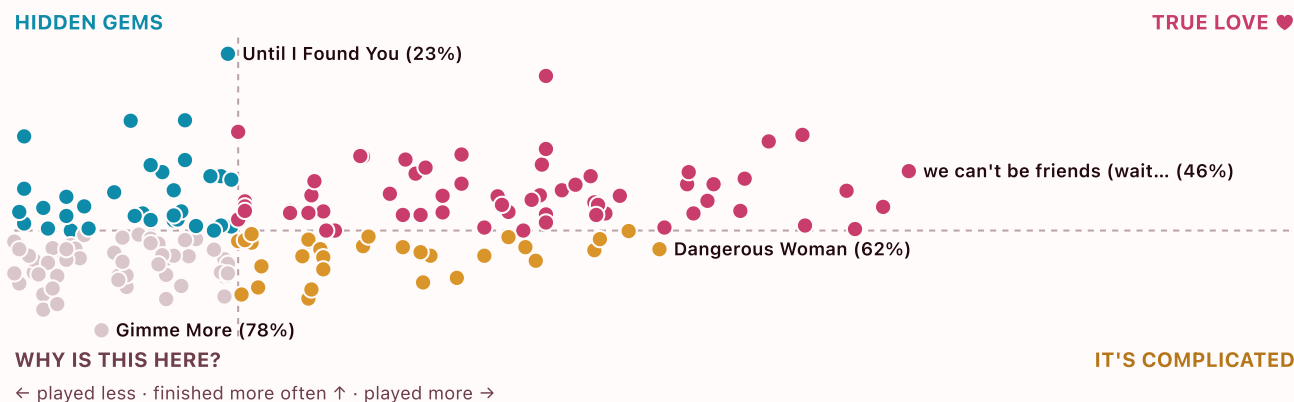
THE TRAPDOOR · SKIP RATE OF ARTISTS I'VE PLAYED 200+ TIMES

Who survives the skip button, and who falls through



SCATTER · SONGS WITH 120+ LISTENS

Do I actually finish the songs I claim to love?



The victims: Nicki Minaj (86%, gone in 1.5s), Megan Thee Stallion (85%, gone in 1.8s), Pitbull (85%, gone in 1.4s), Drake (85%, gone in 6.2s), Bad Bunny (84%, gone in 12.4s). They keep showing up on shuffle and in playlists; I keep pressing next.

The survivors: Stephen Sanchez, Shashwat Sachdev, The Doorbeen, Ariana Grande, PLVTINUM.

True love is "we can't be friends (wait for your love)": 542 listens and skipped only 46% of the time.

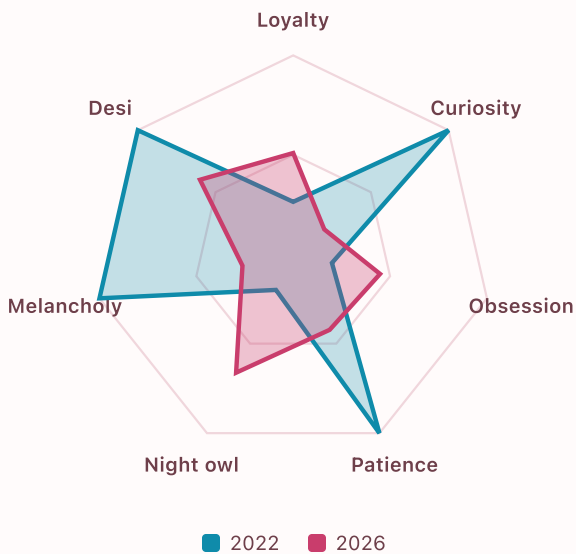
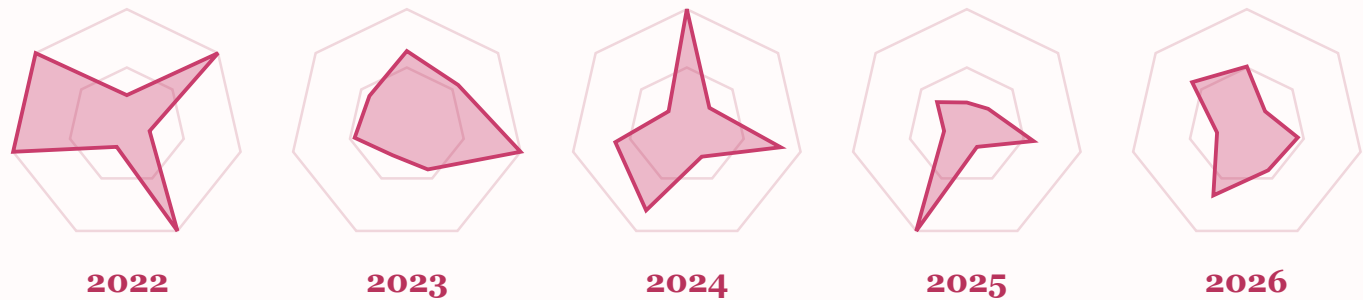
It's complicated with "Dangerous Woman": 356 listens, but I skip it 62% of the times it starts.

A skip isn't always a verdict: autoplay, a playlist I didn't make, or a song that came on at the wrong time all count. Read these as habits, not reviews.

Am I the same listener I was in 2022?

My taste didn't just change. The way I listen did.

LISTENING FINGERPRINTS · EACH YEAR SCALED AGAINST MY OTHER YEARS (AXES LABELED ON THE BIG CHART)



THEN VS. NOW

2022 me vs. 2026 me

	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Loyalty % to top 10 artists	52	63.4	74.2	50.1	59.4
Curiosity % new songs	100	57.6	27.1	25.8	22.5
Obsession listens per song	5.5	14.2	12.3	9.7	8.2
Patience % not skipped	67.6	38.2	32.1	27.4	38.6
Night owl % after midnight	8.4	9.3	15.2	17.4	13.6
Melancholy % sad songs	52	38	42.4	31.3	32.9
Desi % desi	18.2	12.6	10.6	11.8	14.4

2022 ME'S TOP 5 ARTISTS

1		Ariana Grande	36 h
2		Chase Atlantic	16 h
3		Billie Eilish	15 h
4		Olivia Rodrigo	9 h
5		Doja Cat	8 h

2024 was my most loyal year and 2022 my most curious. 2023 was peak obsession: the most listens per song.

2026 ME'S TOP 5 ARTISTS

1		Ariana Grande	228 h
2		Olivia Rodrigo	47 h
3		Rihanna	47 h
4		Taylor Swift	45 h
5		Tate McRae	34 h

2025 was the night-owl year, 2022 the most melancholy and 2025 the least.

So, am I the same listener? The artists barely changed. Everything about how I listen did.

So what did all these listens tell me?

I thought I was analyzing what I listened to. I ended up analyzing how I listen.

I repeat things until they become eras. 119 plays of one song in one day; 21 days in a row of another.

I return to the same artist, Ariana Grande, for 43 of 53 months, while constantly wandering into new songs, more in some years than others.

My music got brighter. In 2022, 52% of what I played was heartbreak, bittersweet or dark; by 2026, 33%.

My taste changes with the hour. Daylight me plays Ariana. 2 AM me plays Shashwat Sachdev. And I've been up with my music until dawn 30 times.

Spotify recorded the songs. The interesting part was everything hiding between them.

FOUR YEARS LATER, THIS IS WHAT IT ALL ADDED UP TO

91,210

LISTENS

4,397

HOURS

4,648

SONGS

1,231

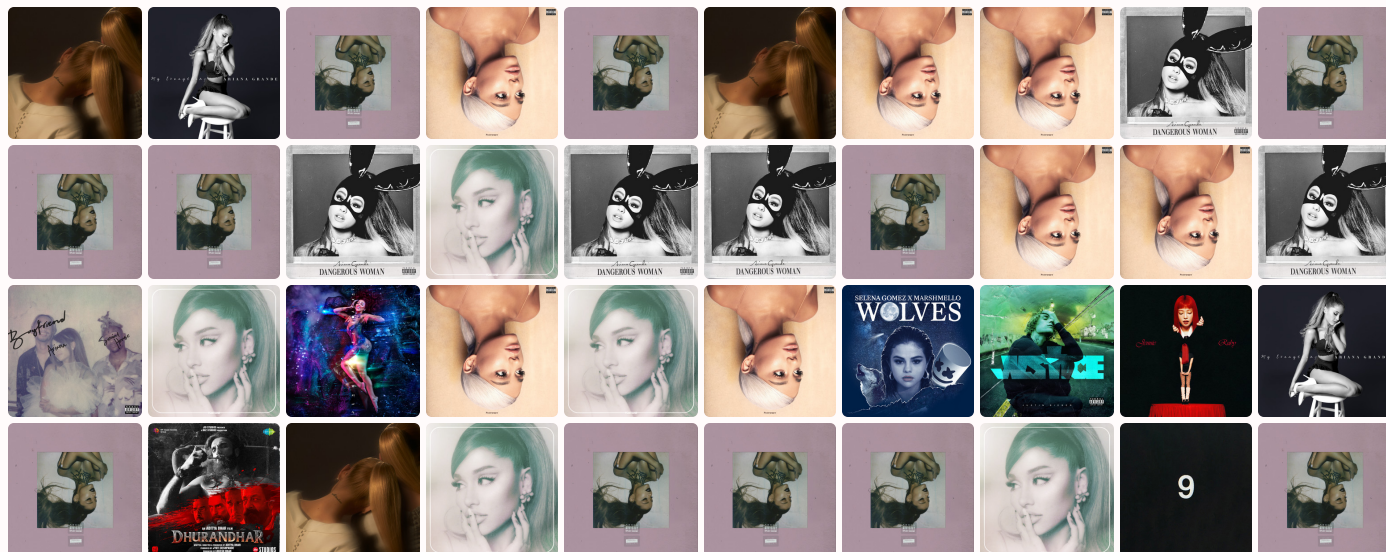
ARTISTS

5,053

SESSIONS

30

ALL-NIGHTERS



Okay, but can you trust any of this?

Here's how I found all of it, and where it stops being evidence.

How the receipts were made

- **Extract:** Python reads Spotify's extended streaming history, every play since May 2022.
- **Clean:** songs only, Austin time, duplicates removed, one song released under many IDs merged into one, plays grouped into sessions.
- **Model:** a star schema in PostgreSQL: one fact table of plays and five dimensions (song, artist, album, day, session).
- **Ask:** SQL with CTEs and window functions (gaps and islands for streaks, LAG for comebacks and silences, lift for 2 AM me), served by FastAPI.

What I left out on purpose

- IP address, country and device: dropped before anything is saved. Private sessions: excluded.
- Plays I didn't really make: "Party In The U.S.A." looping overnight (March 21, 2023), "Hate Me" doing the same (January 22, 2025), and every play of "How Far I'll Go" (April 2023), an accident.
- Raw export files: never on GitHub.

The judgment calls

- **Moods** are my own labels for my 389 most-played songs (61.5% of my listens): heartbreak (−2), bittersweet and dark (−1), love and confident (+1), party (+2). A day's weather is the average of its labeled listens (10 or more); "saddest-sounding" needs 40.
- **Desi** means South Asian music, Hindi, Punjabi or Urdu, from my own list of 87 artists in my top 300.
- **Eras** split at my graduation (June 1, 2024) and my move to Austin (August 15, 2024).
- **2 AM me** uses lift: how much more likely an artist is in that part of the day than across my whole day (artists with 150+ listens).

Definitions

Listen	A play of 30 seconds or more, Spotify's own rule for a stream. Charts count listens unless they say plays.
Skip	A play I moved past with the forward button or quit before 30 seconds.
Streak	Days in a row with at least one listen of the same song.
All-nighter	A night with music in every hour from midnight to 6 AM.
Comeback	A song with 40+ listens, then 180+ days of silence, then 25+ listens within 60 days.

Where it stops being evidence

- A play means the song was on, not that I was listening, awake or feeling it. A sad song isn't proof of a sad day.
- Spotify only: no YouTube, radio or someone else's aux. 2022 starts in late May and 2026 stops in September.